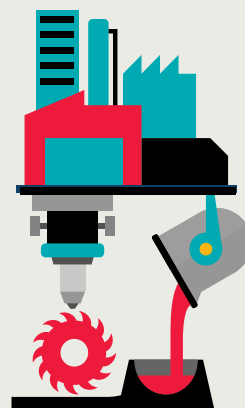




CHARTING A GROWTH PATH

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Creating more awareness about the usage of stainless steel | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Capacity expansion of ₹5,400 crore announced in May 2024 well under way | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Tapping into new export markets in the Middle East and South America |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Jindal Stainless Academy is training fabricators, reaching out to students | | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Investing in renewable capacity to meet EU's rules, become more sustainable |



in a joint venture for a 1.2 MTPA stainless steel melt shop in Indonesia, expansion of downstream capacity in Jajpur, Odisha, and acquisition of 54% equity stake in Chromeni Steels in Mundra, Gujarat. This is expected to help ramp up production capacity to 4.2 million tonnes of annual melt capacity by FY27 in its quest to “achieve global leadership in stainless steel”.

Prasad of Magadh Capital says expanding capacities in a cost-effective manner can help the company in industry consolidation. “As the market leader in a steadily growing commodity, it makes sense to enhance entry barriers for potential entrants and curb competitive positioning of existing players,” he says.

Over the years, Jindal Stainless has put all the building blocks in place in terms of capacity, quality and research and development. The next step is creating more awareness about the usage of steel.

“What is still missing in the country is awareness about stainless steel. This material is inherently corrosion resistant, sustainable and follows a circular economy. Our job as the industry leader is to create more awareness about stainless steel, and that is one of the activities that we are now pursuing,” says Jindal.

Through the Jindal Stainless Academy, the company is using a two-pronged strategy—one, to create more awareness about the benefits of stainless steel among students of engineering, architecture, and railway colleges; and second, to start industrial and fabricator training programmes.

“We have gone for a big programme of training fabricators, which has been running for close to three years now, and we’ve trained almost 35,000 fabricators this year,” Jindal says. He plans to increase that almost threefold.

Another big bet is in renewable capacity. This is partly because of the carbon border adjustment mechanism or CBAM regulation of the European Union. Jindal says it is also a key sustainability initiative to reduce the carbon footprint. “Being a global citizen, we would like to keep our country and our world as clean and green as possible,” he says.

Jindal says following the announcement of CBAM, the company decided to spend about ₹700 crore to ₹800 crore to increase its renewable capacity. “We would like to export at least 30% of our output. Europe is a focus market for us,” he says. Now any expansion that the company does will be backed by renewable energy.

But it is not all smooth sailing. One of the challenges is the abundance of unorganised, subsidised, and sub-standard imports. A lot of the stainless steel being imported is in the wrong grade. This ends up giving stainless steel a bad name, Jindal points out.

Jindal Stainless is waiting to see how US tariffs on steel and aluminium imports plays out. Though it could lead to dumping in India, he points out that the 25% duty was announced by US President Donald Trump in his first term for Indian steel, stainless steel, and aluminium. Any such across-the-board levy would actually level the playing field for India.

A fitness enthusiast and a keen reader of non-fiction, preferably business and management books, Jindal was last October appointed as the President of the Indian Chamber of Commerce.

Clearly, just like the stainless steel his company produces, Jindal is working to make the company inherently strong and timeless. **BT**

@surabhi_prasad